Seicho brand manual
2026, A 72-page brand manual for an imaginary journaling brand, created from scratch.

Context
Seicho is a brand I invented for a brief: a stationery label built on the idea that small thoughts and everyday moments shape who we become. Its name means “growth” in Japanese, its logo is a four-leaf clover, and its journals use prompts and multi-year formats so people can see their own growth over time. With no client, I wrote the brand’s purpose myself and designed everything around it.

My role
Sole designer and author of the brand. With no client or existing identity to work from, I defined Seicho’s purpose and audience, designed the clover logo and visual identity, built the system of colour, type and layout around it, and laid out and wrote the full manual.

Process
I began by defining what the brand believes: its mission, vision and values simplicity, and the people it’s for - introspective students, writers and young professionals who want structure, not a blank page. The identity grew from the clover, which stands for something personal and rare. Multiple logo directions were tested before I settled on one.

Outcome
A 72-page manual covering the brand, with mockups showing how the brand would appear in use.It shows I can invent a brand, give it a clear point of view, and carry it through a complete, consistent system.


seicho

Brand Overview

Seicho is a journaling brand centred around the idea of growth as a slow and ongoing process. It is designed to encourage reflection, helping individuals revisit their thoughts and understand how they change over time.

Unlike conventional journaling products that focus on daily productivity or constant output, Seicho takes a more intentional approach. Its journals are structured to guide users through moments of pause, allowing them to observe patterns, emotions, and personal shifts across longer periods.

The brand is built on simplicity and restraint, both in its design and its philosophy. It avoids visual and conceptual clutter, creating space for the user's thoughts to remain the focus. Through this, Seicho aims to make journaling feel less overwhelming and more accessible as a consistent, personal practice.

At its core, Seicho is not just about documenting experiences, but about recognising growth in its most gradual and often unnoticed forms.



Primary Logo

Seicho's primary logo is a combination mark, consisting of a clean wordmark paired with a minimal clover symbol. The wordmark ensures clarity and recognisability, while the clover subtly represents growth.

The clover is positioned as a quiet accent above the wordmark, creating a balanced and uncluttered composition. This allows the symbol to support the identity without overpowering it, maintaining the brand's calm and minimal aesthetic.

Together, the elements form a cohesive and versatile identity that reflects Seicho's core idea of gradual, ongoing growth.



Secondary Logo

The secondary logo consists of two four-leaf clovers layered in different scales, representing growth over time. The larger form reflects the present, while the smaller suggests an earlier stage, creating a sense of gradual progression.

Designed to function independently, the mark is simple, recognisable, and suitable for smaller applications while maintaining Seicho's calm and minimal aesthetic.



Colour Codes

These colours work together to create a soft and balanced palette. The darker tones provide contrast and structure, while the lighter tones introduce subtle variation across applications. The palette is used consistently to maintain clarity and a minimal visual identity.

Olive Green

CMYK	RGB	HEX
C: 39%	R: 156	#9CB857
M: 12%	G: 184	Pantone
Y: 66%	B: 87	7490 C
K: 0%		

Light Lime Green

CMYK	RGB	HEX
C: 16%	R: 214	#D6FC9E
M: 1%	G: 252	Pantone
Y: 38%	B: 158	372 C
K: 0%		

Moss Green

CMYK	RGB	HEX
C: 47%	R: 131	#83B761
M: 26%	G: 183	Pantone
Y: 61%	B: 97	7489 C
K: 3%		

Forest Green

CMYK	RGB	HEX
C: 58%	R: 98	#62A740
M: 28%	G: 167	Pantone
Y: 87%	B: 64	7739 C
K: 9%		

Pale Mint Green

CMYK	RGB	HEX
C: 2%	R: 250	#FAFFEB
M: 0%	G: 255	Pantone
Y: 8%	B: 235	600 C
K: 0%		

Primary Typeface

Arial Rounded MT Bold

Arial Rounded MT Bold is a soft and approachable sans-serif typeface characterised by its rounded edges and clean structure. Its smooth letterforms create a friendly and accessible tone, while still maintaining clarity and readability across both print and digital applications.

The typeface brings a sense of warmth and simplicity to the brand, aligning with Seicho's calm and minimal identity. Its balanced proportions and consistent stroke weight allow it to function effectively in headings, logos, and key brand elements,
ensuring a cohesive and recognisable visual presence.

This font is the primary typeface of Seicho and forms the basis of the brand's logo.



Secondary Typeface

Svatoplunk

Svatoplunk is used as the secondary typeface for Seicho, primarily across the brand manual, headings, subheadings, and product mockups. Its distinct and expressive form adds character to the overall visual identity while complementing the simplicity of the primary typeface.

The font helps establish a clear hierarchy in communication, making key information stand out without overwhelming the design. When paired with Arial Rounded MT Bold, it creates a balanced contrast between clarity and personality, allowing the brand to remain minimal while still visually engaging.

Aa Svatoplunk Regular

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ]
{ } ; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Aa Bold

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ]
{ } ; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Aa Medium

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ]
{ } ; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Aa Black

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ]
{ } ; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Aa Semi Bold

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ]
{ } ; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Secondary Typeface

Helvetica Neue

Helvetica Neue is used as a secondary typeface across Seicho's mockups and supporting applications. Known for its clean and neutral design, it provides high readability and works well for body text and detailed information.

Its simplicity allows it to blend seamlessly with the brand's overall aesthetic without drawing attention away from the primary elements. When used alongside Arial Rounded MT Bold and Svatoplunk, it helps maintain a balanced and structured typographic system.

Aa Helvetica Neue Regular

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ] {
} ; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Aa Helvetica Neue Medium

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ] { }
; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Aa Helvetica Neue Medium

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm
Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz
0123456789 ! @ # $ % ^ & * ( )*- _ = + [ ] { }
; : ‘ “ , . < > / ? | *

Business Cards

Mockup



Letterhead

Mockup



Journals

Mockup

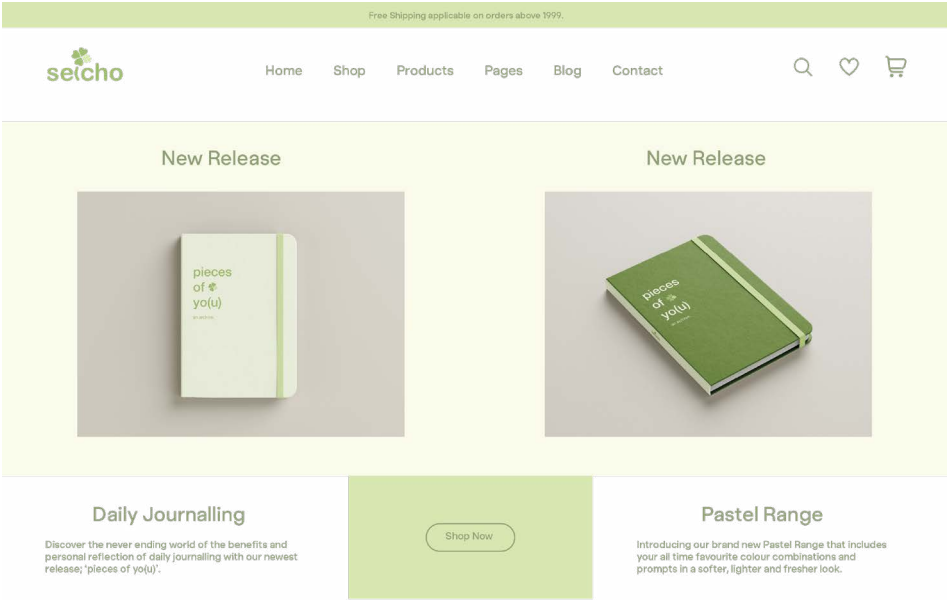


Journals

Mockup



Website Design



Outdoor Signages

A wall-mounted lightbox provides visibility without visual dominance. The white geometric form contrasts with the building surface while maintaining an uncluttered appearance. The logo is applied with precise alignment to ensure legibility from a distance. It serves as a steady, illuminated marker for the brand.



Event Booth & Display



Link to the full brand manual :
https://heyzine.com/flip-book/4a496f69c6.html